Irregular Verbs

Name: _____

The fifty most common irregular verbs

Date: _____

Key terms

Infinitive: the basic form of a verb, usually with *to*: *to sing*.
Past simple: used for finished actions in the past: *Yesterday I sang in the choir.*
Past participle: used with *have*, *has* or *had*: *I have sung in the choir since 2020.*
Irregular verb: a verb whose past forms do not end in *-ed*. You have to learn them by heart.
Pattern: irregular verbs fall into groups. Some have one form for everything (A-A-A), some have two forms the same (A-B-B), in some the past participle is the same as the infinitive (A-B-A) and some have three different forms (A-B-C).

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle	Pattern
to hit	hit	hit	A-A-A
to sleep	slept	slept	A-B-B
to sing	sang	sung	A-B-C

1. Irregular verbs: past simple

Draw a line from each infinitive to its past simple form.

Infinitive		Past simple
to say	•	• understood
to mean	•	• had
to stand	•	• said
to understand	•	• stood
to do	•	• found
to get	•	• made
to make	•	• got
to hear	•	• did
to have	•	• meant
to find	•	• heard

2. Irregular verbs: past participle

Draw a line from each infinitive to its past participle.

Infinitive		Past participle
to be	•	• given
to go	•	• written
to know	•	• begun
to begin	•	• drawn
to take	•	• gone
to give	•	• known
to draw	•	• seen
to speak	•	• taken
to write	•	• been
to see	•	• spoken

3. One form for everything

These verbs have the same form in all three columns. Complete the table. (Careful: the past forms of to read are spelt the same but pronounced like red.)

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to put		
to let		
to set		
to cut		
to read		

4. Two forms the same (1)

The past simple and the past participle are the same. Complete the table.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to have		
to say		
to get		
to make		
to think		
to find		
to tell		
to leave		
to feel		
to bring		
to keep		
to hold		
to stand		

5. Two forms the same (2)

Now some infinitives are missing, too. Complete the table.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to hear		
	meant	
to meet		
to pay		
	sat	
to lead		
	lost	
to send		
to build		
	understood	
to spend		
	bought	

6. Back to the start

The past participle is the same as the infinitive. Complete the table.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to come		
to become		
to run		

7. Three different forms (1)

All three forms are different. Complete the table.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to be		
to do		
to go		
to know		
to take		
to see		
to give		
to begin		
to write		

8. Three different forms (2)

Complete the table. One form is given in each row.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to speak		
	grew	
to fall		
		drawn
to break		
	drove	
to eat		
		chosen

9. Odd one out

Three verbs in each line follow the same pattern. Write the one that does not.

1. put cut take let .....
2. come run go become .....
3. tell keep write meet .....
4. speak break buy choose .....
5. know grow find draw .....
6. set sit cut read .....
7. bring think drive buy .....
8. feel keep eat mean .....

10. Past simple

Put the verb in brackets into the past simple.

1. Last summer we ..... (*to go*) to Scotland.
2. I ..... (*to see*) your brother at the station this morning.
3. She ..... (*to buy*) a new bike last week.
4. We ..... (*to eat*) far too much at the party.
5. My grandfather ..... (*to build*) this house in 1965.
6. The film ..... (*to begin*) at eight o'clock.
7. He ..... (*to lose*) his keys on the way home.
8. I ..... (*to think*) the test was quite easy.
9. My parents ..... (*to meet*) at university.
10. Who ..... (*to break*) the kitchen window?
11. We ..... (*to pay*) for the tickets online.

12. The teacher ..... (*to tell*) us a funny story.

11. Present perfect

Put the verb in brackets into the past participle.

1. Have you ever ..... (*to eat*) sushi?
2. I have ..... (*to know*) her since we were children.
3. She has ..... (*to write*) three books about birds.
4. We haven't ..... (*to see*) that film yet.
5. Has anyone ..... (*to take*) my pen?
6. The temperature has ..... (*to fall*) below zero.
7. He has ..... (*to drive*) all the way from Glasgow.
8. They have ..... (*to choose*) a name for the baby.
9. I have never ..... (*to speak*) to our new neighbours.
10. Have you ..... (*to do*) your homework?
11. It has ..... (*to be*) a very long day.
12. My aunt has ..... (*to give*) me a lot of good advice.

12. Past simple or past participle?

Put the verb in brackets into the correct form.

1. When I was ten, I ..... (*to grow*) ten centimetres in one year.
2. Look how tall you have ..... (*to grow*)!
3. She ..... (*to leave*) the office at six o'clock.
4. Has the train already ..... (*to leave*)?
5. He ..... (*to fall*) off his bike yesterday.
6. Somebody has ..... (*to break*) my glasses.

7. We ..... (*to come*) home very late last night.

8. I'm so glad you have ..... (*to come*) to visit us.

9. I ..... (*to run*) five kilometres this morning.

10. Have you ever ..... (*to run*) a marathon?

11. Last year my cousin ..... (*to become*) a teacher.

12. My little sister has ..... (*to become*) very good at chess.

13. I ..... (*to hear*) a strange noise in the night.

14. Have you ..... (*to hear*) the news?

13. Choose the verb

Choose a verb from the box and put it into the past simple. Use each verb once.

to bring	to feel	to hold	to keep	to lead	to send	to sit	to spend	to stand

1. We ..... in the garden all afternoon.

2. She ..... me a postcard from Rome.

3. I ..... very tired after the long walk.

4. The guide ..... us through the old town.

5. He ..... the baby very carefully.

6. They ..... all their money on a new car.

7. My friend ..... a cake to the party.

8. We ..... in the rain for an hour.

9. She ..... all his letters in a box.

14. Find the mistake

Each sentence has one wrong verb form. Write the correct form.

1. Yesterday I *buyed* a new jacket. .....
2. She has *wrote* a letter to the newspaper. .....
3. We *goed* to the beach last weekend. .....
4. Have you ever *drove* a lorry? .....
5. He *thinked* the answer was wrong. .....
6. I have *knew* him for years. .....
7. The children have *ate* all the biscuits. .....
8. In the end, he *choosed* the red one. .....
9. The glass has *fell* off the table. .....
10. I *seen* him in town yesterday. .....

15. Anna's Saturday

Read the story and put the verbs in brackets into the past simple.

Last Saturday, Anna ..... (*to get*) up early. She ..... (*to have*) a quick breakfast and ..... (*to put*) on her coat. Then she ..... (*to drive*) to the station and ..... (*to take*) the train to the city. On the train she ..... (*to read*) a magazine and ..... (*to write*) a few postcards. In the city she ..... (*to meet*) her old friend Sam. They ..... (*to sit*) in a café and ..... (*to speak*) for hours. Sam ..... (*to tell*) her all about his new job. Later they ..... (*to go*) to a bookshop, and Anna ..... (*to find*) a book that she ..... (*to know*) her brother would love, so she ..... (*to buy*) it for him. In the evening she ..... (*to come*) home tired but happy and ..... (*to fall*) asleep on the sofa.

16. Your turn: last weekend

Write five sentences about what you did last weekend. Use at least five different irregular verbs from this worksheet.

17. Your turn: have you ever . . . ?

Write three sentences about things you have or have never done. Use to eat, to see and to be.